

companies,” says Vivekanandan M.S., Associate Director and Head of the Directorate of Corporate Relations and Career Services at SRM University (Andhra Pradesh). Hari Om Bansal, Unit Chief of Placements at BITS Pilani, says IT services firms were in vogue 8-10 years ago. “Now, IT product firms have taken over. They pay better, roles are more challenging and offer better exposure through foreign trips and students from premiere institutes prefer them,” he says, referring to firms like Microsoft, Amazon, Flipkart, Cisco and Oracle.

pay and specialised roles within the same company. “This shows that IT services companies are trying to address students’ aspirations.”

“Apart from regular roles that pay ₹3.5-4 LPA, the same companies offer a digital profile with a higher compensation of, say, ₹7 LPA,” says SRM’s Vivekanandan, adding that there is some interest from students for niche roles focussed on machine learning and cybersecurity. “The maximum pay services firms offer is ₹5-6 LPA, whereas product companies offer a minimum of ₹14-15 LPA. The difference is stark even

tion for freshers is determined by the skills they have demonstrated during the selection process,” says TechM’s Soin.

MEANWHILE, **TECHNOLOGY** careers are no longer limited to IT services. Sectors such as financial services and automobiles continue to hire in good numbers for their tech functions, while consulting firms like the Big 4 auditors also recruit from engineering colleges, say hiring experts. Besides, the estimated 1,500 Global

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As starting pay has stagnated at ₹3.5-4 lakh per annum in IT services, students are turning elsewhere.

Product firms like Amazon and Google pay ₹10-15 lakh. Other industries such as banking and auto have also ramped up tech hiring



Global Capacity Centres (GCCs) in India are also stepping up hiring. They added a net 150,000 jobs in FY23, closing the year with a headcount of 1.6 million



The IT services companies themselves offer differentiated roles with higher salaries at select colleges, but top-tier colleges have reduced their reliance on them for campus placements

Colleges attribute the trend to low entry-level salaries that have stagnated at ₹3.5-4 lakh per annum (LPA) for over a decade, while the IT services industry’s exports have grown multi-fold.

To attract youngsters with aspirations, several top IT companies have implemented differential hiring. For example, K.V. Sriram, Associate Director of Industry Liaison, Placement & Practice School at Manipal Institute of Technology, says that after receiving the initial offer, students can qualify for better

compared to the niche roles that offer, say, ₹10 LPA,” says BITS Pilani’s Bansal, adding that the college is hosting just a few IT services firms and only for their niche roles for which two to three students get picked. Besides, SRM’s Vivekanandan says, product firms also hire in good numbers, referring to a financial product company that recruited 150 students last year from his college for a compensation of ₹15 LPA.

“We have designed salaries tailored to each employee’s skill set and job relevance. The remunera-

Capacity Centres (GCCs) in India added a net 150,000 jobs in FY23, closing the year with a headcount of 1.6 million, according to tech talent provider NLB Services.

“We train all our computer science and non-computer science students in programming languages and competitive coding, which enables them to get into top consulting, analytics and product companies that recruit them for tech skills. We also attract the top core engineering companies,” says V. Samuel Rajkumar, Director of the Career